

SOP-PTW-4400: General Permit-to-Work System

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Section 1. Purpose and Scope

Establishes the umbrella permit-to-work framework coordinating hot work, confined space, LOTO, excavation, and other high-hazard work permits so overlapping hazards between simultaneous jobs are identified.

Section 2. Permit Coordination

Clause 2.1 — Before any high-hazard permit is issued, the Area Authority shall check the site's active permit board for other work in the same or an adjacent area that could create a combined hazard (e.g., hot work near an open confined space entry, or excavation near an active lift's exclusion zone).

Clause 2.2 — Two permits creating a combined hazard shall not both be active simultaneously in the same area unless a documented simultaneous operations (SIMOPS) review has assessed and controlled the combined risk.

Section 3. Person in Charge

Clause 3.1 — Every permit designates a Person in Charge (PIC) responsible for verifying conditions remain safe for the permit's duration; the PIC shall suspend work immediately if conditions change from those the permit was issued against.

Section 4. Permit Validity

Clause 4.1 — A permit is valid for one shift unless otherwise specified by the specific governing procedure (e.g., hot work permits per SOP-FIRE-610); a permit extending beyond its stated validity requires re-verification of conditions and re-issuance, not an informal extension.

Section 5. Records

Clause 5.1 — Closed permits are filed to the Safety Department File and retained per the specific permit type's governing procedure, or 3 years by default.